Tony Lin

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Education

University of South Carolina – Columbia, S.C. **Anticipated Spring 2026**

- *Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Concentration: Cybersecurity*

Experience

US ARMY RESERVE **November 2022 – Present**

Signal Operations Support Specialist

- Led the establishment and operation of critical communication systems within Tactical Operations Centers (TOCs) to ensure seamless command and control during field deployments.
- Developed and delivered comprehensive training modules on TOC setup, equipment packing lists, and operational guides to significantly enhance overall team readiness.
- Instructed personnel on AN/PRC-148 (MBITR) and RT-1523 radio operation, utilizing hands-on methods to improve unit proficiency in critical communication protocols.
- Performed preventative and corrective maintenance on diverse communication devices and power generators, utilizing diagnostic tools to minimize system disruptions and ensure consistent operational readiness

University of South Carolina Capstone Project **August 2025 – Present**

Software Engineer

- Developing a Python-based web application using Django, PostgreSQL, and Gemini AI API to automate facility data summarization and reporting.
- Designed a hybrid web architecture combining dynamic JavaScript components with Django's server-rendered templates for a responsive user experience.
- Implemented Celery and Redis for asynchronous task processing, enabling background AI report generation while maintaining responsive user experience.
- Built a PostgreSQL-backed data layer supporting multi-user access, permission management, and future scalability for client deployment.
- Integrated Gemini AI for automated text generation and summarization of facility analytics using processed datasets.

Life Cycle Engineering **May 2025 – August 2025**

Systems Administrator/Cybersecurity Professional

- Architected and deployed virtualized security environments with VMware ESXi, then hardened Red Hat Linux and Windows Server VMs using DISA STIGs (RMF Steps 2 & 3) for penetration testing.
- Automated system hardening and configuration tasks with Ansible, ensuring consistent deployment of security baselines to meet NIST STIG and DoD compliance.
- Executed automated security assessments on RHEL systems, aligning with RMF Step 4, using SCAP Compliance Checker (SCC) and Nessus to identify Cat I, II, & III vulnerabilities and documenting findings in POA&Ms for remediation
- Supported RMF compliance (RMF Steps 4 & 6) by validating system hardening with STIG Viewer and continuously monitoring security posture through Splunk log analysis for threat detection and incident response.
- Developed and deployed diverse Capture-the-Flag (CTF) challenges in Docker containers, incorporating initial access, web application (XSS, IDOR, RCE), and specialized service vulnerabilities.

- Engineered advanced CTF scenarios featuring complex directory service (LDAP) and DNS vulnerabilities, challenging participants with credential extraction, privilege escalation, and unauthenticated zone transfers.
- Integrated various network service and misconfiguration vulnerabilities (e.g., FTP, SUDO, CUPS, SNMP, SMB) into CTF challenges to simulate real-world ethical hacking scenarios.

Certifications & Clearance

- **DOD Security Clearance**: Secret
- **Certifications**: CompTIA Security+ CE, CompTIA Network+ CE, CompTIA Server+ CE